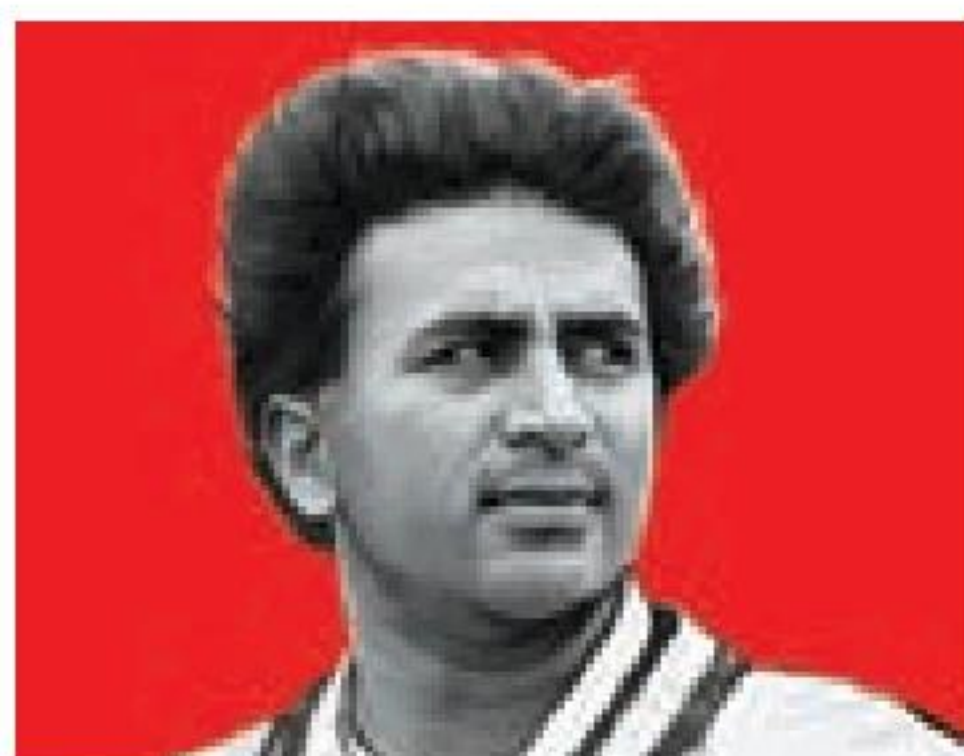




ON THE WRITE LINE

Sunil Gavaskar



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WOMEN'S ODI WORLD CUP WIN HAS TO GO DOWN AS ONE OF THE BEST WINS IN HISTORY OF INDIAN CRICKET

Just like the 1983 win galvanised Indian cricket, this win will give **new wings** to women's cricket.

It was third time lucky for the Indian women as they kept their nerve to win the coveted ICC ODI World Cup. They had been in two finals before and had lost narrowly the last time to England at Lord's, where, for the first time in decades, the English supporters outnumbered the Indian supporters at the ground. The loss by nine runs was hard to take, as the Indians were cruising to a win till Harmanpreet Kaur, who was batting beautifully, got caught at deep square leg. After that, panic and indecision seemed to set in, resulting in a few run-outs and poor shot selection, which ultimately led to the loss.

This time, it was Harmanpreet who was the captain, and she sealed the win with a spectacular catch. This has to go down as one of the best wins in the history of Indian cricket — both in the men's and women's game. The determination shown by the women was incredible. If one may be permitted to say so,

it is a '*khadoos attitude*' that Mumbai cricket is famous for. The coach, Amol Muzumdar, being from Mumbai, must have influenced it a great deal, for to bounce back the way they did after losing three close games is nothing short of remarkable.

The win once again emphasised, if ever it was needed, that sporting intelligence wins trophies, not fancy degrees from universities. It also proves that it will invariably be Indian coaches who get the best results since they know the players — their strengths, weaknesses, and temperament — and understand the nuances of Indian cricket better than any foreigner, however accomplished he or she may be.

There were some who tried to compare this win with the men's team winning the World Cup in 1983. The men had never progressed beyond the group stage in earlier editions, and so everything from the knockout stage onward was new to them, while the